Persist Week of January 26, 2025

REMINDER: Persist is no longer accessible through ATOM. To continue using Persist, you must log in through our new app. If you have not received your login instructions or are experiencing any issues, please contact us at **support@functional-bodybuilding.com**

We will continue to send a PDF version of training in our Persist only weekly newsletters.

This document may be created in advance of edits to the ongoing tracks in Persist, so while we try to minimize these discrepancies as much as possible, the version displayed in our app is always the most up to date. As always, please reach out using the chat bubble in our FBB app or on our website at https://functional-bodybuilding.com if you have any questions about the programming. It may be helpful to look over the week ahead to make sure your questions are all answered in time for your workout.

Pump Lift 5x
- Monday January 26, 2026
- Tuesday January 27, 2026
- Wednesday January 28, 2026
- Thursday January 29, 2026
- Friday January 30, 2026
- Saturday January 31, 2026
- Sunday February 1, 2026

Pump Lift 4x
- Monday January 26, 2026
- Tuesday January 27, 2026
- Wednesday January 28, 2026
- Thursday January 29, 2026
- Friday January 30, 2026
- Saturday January 31, 2026
- Sunday February 1, 2026

Pump Lift 3x
- Monday January 26, 2026
- Tuesday January 27, 2026
- Wednesday January 28, 2026
- Thursday January 29, 2026
- Friday January 30, 2026
- Saturday January 31, 2026
- Sunday February 1, 2026

- Pump Condition 5x
  - Monday January 26, 2026
  - Tuesday January 27, 2026
  - Wednesday January 28, 2026
  - Thursday January 29, 2026
  - Friday January 30, 2026
  - Saturday January 31, 2026
  - Sunday February 1, 2026
- Pump Condition 4x
  - Monday January 26, 2026
  - Tuesday January 27, 2026
  - Wednesday January 28, 2026
  - Thursday January 29, 2026
  - Friday January 30, 2026
  - Saturday January 31, 2026
  - Sunday February 1, 2026
- Pump Condition 3x
  - Monday January 26, 2026
  - Tuesday January 27, 2026
  - Wednesday January 28, 2026
  - Thursday January 29, 2026
  - Friday January 30, 2026
  - Saturday January 31, 2026
  - Sunday February 1, 2026
- Perform
  - Monday January 26, 2026
  - Tuesday January 27, 2026
  - Wednesday January 28, 2026
  - Thursday January 29, 2026
  - Friday January 30, 2026
  - Saturday January 31, 2026
  - Sunday February 1, 2026
- Minimalist
  - Monday January 26, 2026
  - Tuesday January 27, 2026
  - Wednesday January 28, 2026
  - Thursday January 29, 2026

Friday January 30, 2026
Saturday January 31, 2026
Sunday February 1, 2026

Pump Lift 5x

Monday January 26, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 – Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
RDL Progression and Rep Consistency
This week continues the RDL progression. The reps stay the same each week on purpose — that way, you only need to adjust the weight and focus on perfect form. Fewer changes mean more consistency and better long-term results.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Split Stance Dual KB Deadlift; 8–10 reps/side
Split Stance Dual KB Row; 6–8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set – 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo – Easy
Working Set 1 – 10 @ 20X1 – RPE 7
Working Set 2 – 10 @ 20X1 – RPE 8
Working Set 3 – 10 @ 20X1 – RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10 where 10 is form failure). The reps are the same as Week 1+3, aim to increase weight by 5–10% from Week 3.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Incline Prone DB Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes

Warm-Up Set – 10 reps @ 20X1 – Easy
Working Set 1 – 12 @ 20X1 – RPE 7
Working Set 2 – 12 @ 20X1 – RPE 8
Working Set 3 – 12 @ 20X1 – RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 10 → 12.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Ring Row or Pronated Body Row; 10 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Dumbbell External Rotation Elbow on Knee; 8–10 reps/side @20X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2 sets
Alternating DB Bicep Curl Drop Sets
*Select a weight that you can perform for about 10–12 reps. Go to failure with this weight. Then reduce the weight and go to failure again aiming for 6+ reps. Reduce the weight one more time and go to failure again aiming for 6+ reps. This is one set. Rest 3 minutes between sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1–2 sets
Cat Cow × 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch × 30 sec/side
Downdog to Updog × 5 reps with 2–3 sec hold in each position
Pigeon Stretch; 30–60 sec/side

Tuesday January 27, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 – Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Back Supported Vertical Press Benefits
The Back Supported Vertical Press (today you'll see an Arnold Press variation) is great for people with limited shoulder mobility. The bench support allows for the subtlest of lean back if you're

limited getting the shoulder into a completely straight overhead position. Use the back rest only as much as needed.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps
Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (No Pauses at Bottom)
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Back Support DB Arnold Press
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 8 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set. Aim for the last set each week to be close to failure. Aim to increase weight on one set this week compared to your results from Week 3.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 4-8 reps @32X1
rest 30 sec

Inchworm Pushup; 5-7 reps
rest 30 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Cable Cross Body Tricep Extension or Band Cross Body Tricep Extension; 12-20 reps/side
*Switch the starting side each set.
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday January 28, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 – Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Nordic Hamstring Curl: High Sets, Low Reps
The Nordic Hamstring Curl is tough — so this week focuses on more sets with fewer reps to keep the quality high. This helps you train your hamstrings hard without losing form. You should be able to use less assistance than in previous weeks.
Move slow and controlled, keeping your hips extended the whole time for maximum strength benefit.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint
directly into
Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
Landmine Lateral Lunge with Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Dual KB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 2.2.2 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Rep Scheme Note:
2.2.2 Cluster Set = Perform the first 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the next 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the last 2 reps. Each set is 6 total reps with rest between every 2 reps.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Suitcase Knee Over Toe Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 60 sec between all sides and sets
Warm-Up Set - 10/side @ 20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set if you can.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
V Up; 10 reps
rest 30 sec
Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Tuck Up; 20 reps

rest 30 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For the nordic hamstring curl, use assistance as needed to match the prescription. The reps have decreased allowing for a decrease in assistance. Other hamstring curl variations may be subbed in place of the nordic hamstring curl. Aim for each set to be close to failure. The sets have increased again from Week 3+4.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2-3 sets
Hand Supported Suitcase Calf Raise or Machine Calf Raise; 12-20 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Weighted Butterfly Lifts; 12-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday January 29, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 – Active Recovery Day

A) Active Recovery Work:
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a slightly higher effort cardio GYM OPTION, please use the following. Be mindful not to push your intensity too high on the day. Small spikes in heart rate are fine. Just don't attempt to trash your body or muscles.
Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
2 Sets:
8 Dual KB Gunslinger
8 Dual KB Clean
8 Alternating KB Press (4/side)
*keep the KB weight very light
Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort

rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
2 Sets:
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Russian Babymaker x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps/side

Friday January 30, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 – Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Supinated Grip DB Bench Press: Stretch and Control
The Supinated Dumbbell Bench Press is a great way to stretch the chest and build shoulder control. Think of it as halfway between a DB Fly and a regular DB Bench Press. Keep the shoulder blades down and back as you stretch into the bottom.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps
Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 1. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup or Pronated Grip Lat Pull Down
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - RPE 9-10
Working Set 2 - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - RPE 9-10
Working Set 3 - Perform Max UB reps @20X0 - RPE 9-10
Loading Note:
Use assistance as needed to match tempo and rep range. The tempo has changed from Week 3+4. No pause at the top or bottom this week. Aim for each set to be close to failure between the rep range provided.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Seated Bradford Press; 12 reps
rest 60 sec
Supinated Grip Dumbbell Bench Press; 12 reps @20X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Bradford Press, 1 rep = over and back.
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Top Down Incline Alternating DB Bicep Curl; 8-10 reps/side @21X1
rest 30 sec
Incline DB Tricep Kickback or Cable Tricep Kickback; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday January 31, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 – Persist PUMP LIFT 5x

A) Daily Focus Notes:
Tall Kneel to Stand: Strong Glute Drive
The Tall Kneel to Stand starts from a stable, but stretch glute position. Emphasize this strong glute contraction as you stand up. Focus on feeling the glute on your working side as you drive your foot into the floor.
Stay tall at the top and control the return to the kneeling position — this move builds great glute strength and hip control.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Single Leg Hip Bridge Hold; 30 sec/side
Alternating Single Arm Split Stance KB Swing x 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Reps are the same as Week 3 - aim to increase weight by about 5%.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Hand Supported DB Suitcase Box Step Up

3 Working Sets; rest 60 sec between all sides and sets
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps/side @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 reps/side @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 reps/side @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 reps/side @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 1+3. Reps have increased from 8->10.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust or Machine Hip Thrust; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60 sec
Dual KB Rack Tall Kneel to Stand; 6-8 reps/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure with great form.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up; 8-10 reps
rest 30 sec
DB Star Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Seal Stretch; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Sunday February 1, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 – Persist PUMP LIFT 5x
WORK IN LESSON
Lack of motivation isn't a moral failing. Maybe you're trying to force a version of fitness that no longer fits your life.

I understand the fear that if something worked once, it feels like the only way. Changing my training from hours in the gym each day to a handful of hours a week took time, because I was afraid if I stopped doing so much I'd lose all my progress.

For someone who practically lived in the gym, it's actually shocking how little you need when you just do a few things well.

Lift with good effort a few times a week. Walk a lot throughout the day. Manage your calories and protein.

If you're struggling to stay consistent, is there a version that's easier, and still gets the job done?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 4x

Monday January 26, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Incline Prone Dumbbell Row Advantage
The Incline Prone Dumbbell Row is great for building your back, especially when your lower back is already tired from other lifts. Lying face down on the bench supports your body, so you can focus on working your lats, mid-back, and rear shoulders.
Pull your elbows toward your hips and lower the weights slowly. This helps you get a strong back workout without putting stress on your lower back.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps
Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (No Pauses at Bottom)

Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Incline Prone DB Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 10->12.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 4-8 reps @32X1
rest 30 sec
Inchworm Pushup; 5-7 reps
rest 30 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raises; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2 sets
Alternating DB Bicep Curl Drop Sets
*Select a weight that you can perform for about 10-12 reps. Go to failure with this weight. Then reduce the weight and go to failure again aiming for 6+ reps. Reduce the weight one more time and go to failure again aiming for 6+ reps. This is one set. Rest 3 minutes between sets.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday January 27, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Nordic Hamstring Curl: High Sets, Low Reps
The Nordic Hamstring Curl is tough — so this week focuses on more sets with fewer reps to keep the quality high. This helps you train your hamstrings hard without losing form. You should be able to use less assistance than in previous weeks.
Move slow and controlled, keeping your hips extended the whole time for maximum strength benefit.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
directly into
Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
Landmine Lateral Lunge with Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Dual KB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Reps have decreased from Week 3, aim to increase weight by 5-10%.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):

Suitcase Knee Over Toe Split Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 60 sec between all sides and sets
Warm-Up Set - 10/side @ 20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8/side @ 20X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6/side @ 20X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4/side @ 20X0 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Increase weight each set if you can.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
V Up; 10 reps
rest 30 sec
Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Tuck Up; 20 reps
rest 30 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the nordic hamstring curl, use assistance as needed to match the prescription. The reps have decreased allowing for a decrease in assistance. Other hamstring curl variations may be subbed in place of the nordic hamstring curl. Aim for each set to be close to failure. The sets have increased again from Week 3+4.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2-3 sets
Hand Supported Suitcase Calf Raise or Machine Calf Raise; 12-20 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Weighted Butterfly Lifts; 12-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side

Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday January 28, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work : Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Thursday January 29, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Dumbbell Floor Press
The Dumbbell Floor Press is a great way to focus on the triceps and shoulders more directly. Since we remove the bottom portion of the range of motion, this movement doesn't stretch the chest muscle fully. Instead, most of the tension is on the triceps and shoulders.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps
Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Barbell Z Press

4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 1. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Pronated Strict Pullup or Pronated Grip Lat Pull Down
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - RPE 9-10
Working Set 2 - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - RPE 9-10
Working Set 3 - Perform Max Unbroken reps @20X0 - RPE 9-10
Loading Note:
Use assistance as needed to match tempo and rep range. The tempo has changed from Week 3+4. No pause at the top or bottom this week. Aim for each set to be close to failure between the rep range provided.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Alternating Dumbbell Floor Press; 12 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Single Arm Dumbbell Row; 12 reps/side @20X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
DB Overhead Tricep Extension; 10 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Cable Cross Body Tricep Extension or Band Cross Body Tricep Extension; 12-20 reps/side
*Switch the starting side each set.
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Friday January 30, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tall Kneel to Stand: Strong Glute Drive
The Tall Kneel to Stand starts from a stable, but stretch glute position. Emphasize this strong glute contraction as you stand up. Focus on feeling the glute on your working side as you drive your foot into the floor.
Stay tall at the top and control the return to the kneeling position — this move builds great glute strength and hip control.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Single Leg Hip Bridge Hold; 30 sec/side
Alternating Single Arm Split Stance KB Swing x 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Reps are the same as Week 3, aim to increase weight by about 5%.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift

3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. The reps are the same as Week 1+3, aim to increase weight by 5-10% from Week 3.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust or Machine Hip Thrust; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60 sec
Dual KB Rack Tall Kneel to Stand; 6-8 reps/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure with great form.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up; 8-10 reps
rest 30 sec
DB Star Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Seal Stretch; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday January 31, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:

Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Then Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
8 Dual KB Gunslinger
8 Dual KB Clean
8 Alternating KB Press (4/side)
*keep the KB weight very light
Then Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday February 1, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP LIFT 4x
WORK IN LESSON
Lack of motivation isn't a moral failing. Maybe you're trying to force a version of fitness that no longer fits your life.

I understand the fear that if something worked once, it feels like the only way. Changing my training from hours in the gym each day to a handful of hours a week took time, because I was afraid if I stopped doing so much I'd lose all my progress.

For someone who practically lived in the gym, it's actually shocking how little you need when you just do a few things well.

Lift with good effort a few times a week. Walk a lot throughout the day. Manage your calories and protein.

If you're struggling to stay consistent, is there a version that's easier, and still gets the job done?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Lift 3x

Monday January 26, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 – Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tall Kneel to Stand: Strong Glute Drive
The Tall Kneel to Stand starts from a stable, but stretch glute position. Emphasize this strong glute contraction as you stand up. Focus on feeling the glute on your working side as you drive your foot into the floor.
Stay tall at the top and control the return to the kneeling position — this move builds great glute strength and hip control.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps
Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (No Pauses at Bottom)

Loading Note:

Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure). Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Pronated Strict Pull Up or Pronated Grip Lat Pull Down
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - RPE 9-10
Working Set 2 - 8-12 reps @ 20X0 - RPE 9-10
Working Set 3 - Perform Max Unbroken reps @20X0 - RPE 9-10

Loading Note:

Use assistance as needed to match tempo and rep range. The tempo has changed from Week 3+4. The tempo is faster on the way down. Aim for each set to be close to failure between the rep range provided.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust or Machine Hip Thrust; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60 sec
Dual KB Rack Tall Kneel to Stand; 6-8 reps/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure with great form.

F) Finisher (8-10 min):
2-3 sets
Hand Supported Suitcase Calf Raise or Machine Calf Raise; 12-20 reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Weighted Butterfly Lifts; 12-20 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets

Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
Pancake Stretch; 60 sec

Tuesday January 27, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 – Persist PUMP LIFT 3x
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Passive Hang x 1 min

Wednesday January 28, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 – Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: 3 Movement Push Shoulder Complex
In today's Strength Balance section you have 3 exercises back to back that target similar muscle groups. These "Giant Sets" intentionally fatigue similar body parts. We like to start with the hardest and potentially the most intense exercise, and finish with less complex exercises. The idea is that you will attempt to make your first 4-6 reps of dips very hard, maximizing tension and intensity, and then on your final exercises, select a weight that allows you to complete the set even on tired shoulders.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets

15 sec Cardio Sprint
directly into
Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
Landmine Lateral Lunge with Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Dual KB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Reps have decreased from Week 3, aim to increase weight by 5-10%.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (10 min):
Incline Prone DB Row
3 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 12 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 10->12.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 4-6 reps @32X1 (3 seconds down, 2 second pause at bottom)
rest 30 sec
Half Kneeling Single Arm DB Strict Press; 10 reps/side @21X1
rest 30 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up; 8-10 reps
rest 30 sec
DB Star Plank; 20-30 sec/side
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Seal Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Thursday January 29, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 – Persist PUMP LIFT 3x
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Russian Babymaker x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps/side

Friday January 30, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 – Persist PUMP LIFT 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Suitcase Knee Over Toe Split Squat
In the Suitcase Knee Over Toe Split Squat, focus on keeping your front knee lined up over your third toe as you lower down. The goal is to drive the knee as far forward as you can while keeping your heel down on the floor. This places a lot of load on the quads and will help build strength in your knees.
Short on Time? Remove Finisher.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Single Leg Hip Bridge Hold; 30 sec/side
Alternating Single Arm Split Stance KB Swing x 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. The reps are the same as Week 1+3, aim to increase weight by 5-10% from Week 3.

D) Strength Intensity 2 (12 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. Aim to match weight from Week 1. The reps have increased from 8->10.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):

3 sets
Suitcase Knee Over Toe Split Squat (see loading notes)
rest 30 sec
V Up; 12-20 reps
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Suitcase Knee Over Toe Split Squat
Warm-Up Set - 10/side @ 21X0 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 8/side @ 21X0 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6/side @ 21X0 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 4/side @ 21X0 - RPE 9
*Increase weight each set.

F) Finisher (6-8 min):
2-3 sets
Top Down Incline Alternating DB Bicep Curl; 16-20 total reps @21X1
rest 30 sec
Incline DB Tricep Kickback or Cable Tricep Kickback; 12-15 reps @30X0
rest 60 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday January 31, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 – Persist PUMP LIFT 3x
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Then Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec

x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
8 Dual KB Gunslinger
8 Dual KB Clean
8 Alternating KB Press (4/side)
*keep the KB weight very light
Then Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday February 1, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 – Persist PUMP LIFT 3x
WORK IN LESSON
Lack of motivation isn't a moral failing. Maybe you're trying to force a version of fitness that no longer fits your life.

I understand the fear that if something worked once, it feels like the only way. Changing my training from hours in the gym each day to a handful of hours a week took time, because I was afraid if I stopped doing so much I'd lose all my progress.

For someone who practically lived in the gym, it's actually shocking how little you need when you just do a few things well.

Lift with good effort a few times a week. Walk a lot throughout the day. Manage your calories and protein.

If you're struggling to stay consistent, is there a version that's easier, and still gets the job done?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 5x

Monday January 26, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 – Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
Daily Focus Note: Supinated Barbell Row
The supinated position helps guide the elbows into the best position possible for proper lat engagement. While the supinated posture often gets labeled as being more bicep dominant, the improved position of the shoulder and shoulder blades actually contribute to even better lat engagement, compared to its pronated grip counterpart.
Short on Time? Reduce Strength Balance to 2 Sets.
Warm-up (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
2) Split Stance Dual KB Deadlift; 8-10 reps/side
3) Split Stance Dual KB Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - Scale out of 10 where 10 is form failure). The reps are the same as Weeks 1+3, aim to increase weight by 5-10% from Week 3.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3-4 sets
1. Supinated Barbell Row; 6 reps @21X1
- rest 30-60 sec
2. Pronated Strict Pullup; 8-12 reps @20X0
- - rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Density Hinge (15 min):
50/40 Cal Bike Buy In (male/female)
+
3 rounds for time
20 Alternating DB Power Clean (50/35#)
20 Burpee No Jump
30 sec/side Star Plank
Effort Note:
Push the pace on the Buy In and Buy Out. Perform the Rounds For Time in between with a controlled pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
1) Cat Cow x 5 reps
2) Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side
3) Downdog to Updog x 5 reps with 2-3 sec hold in each position
4) Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday January 27, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 – Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
Daily Focus Notes: Half Kneeling DB Press Core Integration
The Half Kneeling Dumbbell Press in the Strength Balance section combines upper body strength with core control. By pressing from a kneeling stance, your abs and glutes must stay tight to keep your body stable. This teaches proper bracing and improves how your core supports overhead pressing. Focus on pressing straight up while keeping your ribs pulled down and hips square.
Short on Time? Reduce Conditioning to 9-12 minutes.
Warm-up (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
1) Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps
2) Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes

Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (No Pauses at Bottom)

Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Strict Bar Dip; 4-6 reps @32X1
- rest 30 sec
2. Half Kneeling Single Arm DB Strict Press; 10 reps/side @21X1
- rest 30 sec
3. Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10 reps @30X0
- - rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Overhead Intervals (12-15 min):
Every 60 sec x 12-15 sets (4-5 rounds)
Min 1) 3-5 Wall Walks or 10-12 Inchworm
Min 2) 10-15 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up (25/10)
Min 3) Row 8-12 Cals
Effort Note:
Perform at a controlled pace to give yourself a small amount of rest time between each minute. The first rounds may feel easy, but they should gradually get more challenging.
Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
1) Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday January 28, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 – Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
Daily Focus Note: Nordic Hamstring Curl: High Sets, Low Reps

The Nordic Hamstring Curl is tough — so this week focuses on more sets with fewer reps to keep the quality high. This helps you train your hamstrings hard without losing form. You should be able to use less assistance than in previous weeks.
Move slow and controlled, keeping your hips extended the whole time for maximum strength benefit.
Short on Time? Reduce conditioning to 3 sets.
Warm-up (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
- directly into
1) Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
2) Landmine Lateral Lunge with Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
3) Dual KB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 2.2.2 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Rep Scheme Note:
2.2.2 Cluster Set = Perform the first 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the next 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the last 2 reps. Each set is 6 total reps with rest between every 2 reps.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
1. Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
- rest 30 sec
2. V Up; 10 reps
- rest 30 sec
3. Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
- rest 30 sec
4. Tuck Up; 20 reps

- - rest 30 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

For the nordic hamstring curl, use assistance as needed to match the prescription. The reps have decreased allowing for a decrease in assistance. Other hamstring curl variations may be subbed in place of the nordic hamstring curl. Aim for each set to be close to failure. The sets have increased again from Weeks 3+4.

E) Lower Body Interval Weight Training (12 min):
Every 3mins x 4 Sets
10/side Dual KB Overhead Box Step Up (35/26) (16-20")
20/16 Calorie Bike
*If overhead position is too challenging, perform a Dual KB Rack Step Up
Effort Note:
Prioritize quality on the lower body movement with a sustainable pace on the bike. Any remaining time of the 3 minutes is rest.
Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 set
1) Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
2) Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
3) Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday January 29, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 – Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a slightly higher effort cardio GYM OPTION, please use the following. Be mindful not to push your intensity too high on the day. Small spikes in heart rate are fine. Just don't attempt to trash your body or muscles.
Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
8 Dual KB Gunslinger
8 Dual KB Clean
8 Alternating KB Press (4/side)
*keep the KB weight very light
Then Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:

10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Russian Babymaker x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps/side

Friday January 30, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 – Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
Daily Focus Note: Fast Intervals with Full Effort
Today's workout uses short, intense intervals with built-in recovery to help you push harder each set. The 1:1 work-to-rest ratio means you will rest the same amount of time it takes to complete each set - so make sure to time yourself. Keep your rows powerful and efficient, then move quickly into the push-ups or body rows with solid form. Focus on smooth transitions and strong pacing. Each round should feel challenging but repeatable, with consistent times from start to finish.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance.
Warm-up (8 min)
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
1) Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps
2) Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 1. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press; 12 reps/side @20X0
- rest 30 sec
2. Dumbbell Preacher Curl; 10 reps @20X0
- rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Couple of Couplets (15 min):
6/5 Cal Row (male/female)
12 KB Gorilla Rows (53/35#) R+L=1
6/5 Cal Row
rest 1:1 x 4 Sets
rest 2 min
6/5 Cal Row
15 Pronated Body Rows
6/5 Cal Row
rest 1:1 x 4 Sets
Effort Note:
For this conditioning piece, make sure to keep track of each round. The time it takes to complete each round, will be the time you will rest between each set. Because of the 1:1 work to rest ratio, push the pace on these intervals.
Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
1) Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
2) Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
3) PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday January 31, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 – Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
Tall Kneel to Stand: Strong Glute Drive
Daily Focus Note:

The Tall Kneel to Stand starts from a stable, but stretch glute position. Emphasize this strong glute contraction as you stand up. Focus on feeling the glute on your working side as you drive your foot into the floor.
Stay tall at the top and control the return to the kneeling position — this move builds great glute strength and hip control.
Short on Time? Reduce Strength Balance to 2 sets.
Warm-up (8 min)
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
1) Single Leg Hip Bridge Hold; 30 sec/side
2) Alternating Single Arm Split Stance KB Swing x 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Reps are the same as Week 3, aim to increase weight by about 5%.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
1. Barbell Hip Thrust or Machine Hip Thrust; 10 reps @20X0
- rest 60 sec
2. Dual KB Rack Tall Kneel to Stand; 6-8 reps/side
- - rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note;
Aim for each set to be close to failure with great form.

E) GRINDER (15 min):
15 minutes @ GRINDER pace
45sec Goblet Wall Sit (53/35)
20 Split Stance Alternating Single Arm Russian Kettlebell Swing (53/35)
50m Goblet Carry (70/53)
30 Bodyweight Walking Lunge (15/side)

Effort Note:
Some movements chosen for this conditioning section are meant to slow you down. Do not try to race through this, instead focus on a consistent trudge through the 15 minutes.
Cooldown (5 min)
1-2 sets
1) Seal Stretch; 30 sec
2) Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
3) Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Sunday February 1, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 – Persist PUMP CONDITION 5x
WORK IN LESSON
Lack of motivation isn't a moral failing. Maybe you're trying to force a version of fitness that no longer fits your life.

I understand the fear that if something worked once, it feels like the only way. Changing my training from hours in the gym each day to a handful of hours a week took time, because I was afraid if I stopped doing so much I'd lose all my progress.

For someone who practically lived in the gym, it's actually shocking how little you need when you just do a few things well.

Lift with good effort a few times a week. Walk a lot throughout the day. Manage your calories and protein.

If you're struggling to stay consistent, is there a version that's easier, and still gets the job done?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 4x

Monday January 26, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression on Pullups
Your pullups this block follow a tempo progression:

Weeks 1–2: 21X2 (steady control and a pause at the top)
Weeks 3–4: 30X0 (longer eccentric to build strength)
Weeks 5–6: 20X0 (faster and more powerful).
The pullup can be a very hard movement to progress, but tempo is a great tool to break through plateaus.
Short on Time? Reduce conditioning to 9 minutes.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps
Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (No Pauses at Bottom)
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10 where 10 is form failure). Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Barbell Row; 6 reps @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Pronated Strict Pullup; 8-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Overhead Intervals (12-15 min):
Every 60 sec x 12-15 sets

Min 1) 3-5 Wall Walks or 10-12 Inchworm
Min 2) 10-15 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up (25/10)
Min 3) Row 8-12 Cals
Effort Note:
Perform at a controlled pace to give yourself a small amount of rest time between each minute. The first rounds may feel easy, but they should gradually get more challenging.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday January 27, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Nordic Hamstring Curl: High Sets, Low Reps
The Nordic Hamstring Curl is tough — so this week focuses on more sets with fewer reps to keep the quality high. This helps you train your hamstrings hard without losing form. You should be able to use less assistance than in previous weeks.
Move slow and controlled, keeping your hips extended the whole time for maximum strength benefit.
Short on Time? Reduce conditioning to 3 sets.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
directly into
Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
Landmine Lateral Lunge with Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Dual KB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 2.2.2 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7

Working Set 2 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Rep Scheme Note:
2.2.2 Cluster Set = Perform the first 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the next 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the last 2 reps. Each set is 6 total reps with rest between every 2 reps.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
V Up; 10 reps
rest 30 sec
Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Tuck Up; 20 reps
rest 30 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the nordic hamstring curl, use assistance as needed to match the prescription. The reps have decreased allowing for a decrease in assistance. Other hamstring curl variations may be subbed in place of the nordic hamstring curl. Aim for each set to be close to failure. The sets have increased again from Week 3+4.

E) Interval Lower Body Weight Training (12min):
Every 3mins x 4 Sets
10/side Dual KB Overhead Box Step Up (35/26) (16-20")
20/16 Calorie Bike
*If overhead position is too challenging, perform a Dual KB Rack Step Up
Effort Note:
Prioritize quality on the lower body movement with a sustainable pace on the bike. Any remaining time of the 3 minutes is rest.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday January 28, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Thursday January 29, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Half Kneeling DB Press Core Integration
The Half Kneeling Dumbbell Press combines upper body strength with core control. By pressing from a kneeling stance, your abs and glutes must stay tight to keep your body stable. This teaches proper bracing and improves how your core supports overhead pressing. Focus on pressing straight up while keeping your ribs pulled down and hips square.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps
Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy

Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 1. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 4-6 reps @32X1
rest 30 sec
Half Kneeling Single Arm DB Strict Press; 10 reps/side @21X1
rest 30 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raises; 10 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Couple of Couplets (15min)
6/5 Cal Row (male/female)
12 KB Gorilla Rows (53/35) R+L=1
6/5 Cal Row
rest 1:1 x 4 Sets
rest 2 min
6/5 Cal Row
15 Pronated Body Rows
6/5 Cal Row
rest 1:1 x 4 Sets
Effort Note:
For this conditioning piece, make sure to keep track of each round. The time it takes to complete each round, will be the time you will rest between each set. Because of the 1:1 work to rest ratio, push the pace on these intervals.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Friday January 30, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tall Kneel to Stand: Strong Glute Drive
The Tall Kneel to Stand starts from a stable, but stretch glute position. Emphasize this strong glute contraction as you stand up. Focus on feeling the glute on your working side as you drive your foot into the floor.
Stay tall at the top and control the return to the kneeling position — this move builds great glute strength and hip control.
Short on Time? Reduce Strength Balance to 2 sets.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Single Leg Hip Bridge Hold; 30 sec/side
Alternating Single Arm Split Stance KB Swing x 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. The reps are the same as Week 1+3, aim to increase weight by 5-10% from Week 3.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust or Machine Hip Thrust; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60 sec
Dual KB Rack Tall Kneel to Stand; 6-8 reps/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note;
Aim for each set to be close to failure with great form.

E) GRINDER (15 min):

15 minutes @ GRINDER pace
45sec Goblet Wall Sit (53/35)
20 Split Stance Alternating Single Arm Russian KBS (53/35)
50m Goblet Carry (70/53)
30 Bodyweight Walking Lunge (15/side)
Effort Note:
Some movements chosen for this conditioning section are meant to slow you down. Do not try to race through this, instead focus on a consistent trudge through the 15 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Seal Stretch; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday January 31, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Then Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
8 Dual KB Gunslinger
8 Dual KB Clean
8 Alternating KB Press (4/side)
*keep the KB weight very light
Then Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side
Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 4x

Sunday February 1, 2026

WORK IN LESSON
Lack of motivation isn't a moral failing. Maybe you're trying to force a version of fitness that no longer fits your life.

I understand the fear that if something worked once, it feels like the only way. Changing my training from hours in the gym each day to a handful of hours a week took time, because I was afraid if I stopped doing so much I'd lose all my progress.

For someone who practically lived in the gym, it's actually shocking how little you need when you just do a few things well.

Lift with good effort a few times a week. Walk a lot throughout the day. Manage your calories and protein.

If you're struggling to stay consistent, is there a version that's easier, and still gets the job done?

With love,
Marcus

Pump Condition 3x

Monday January 26, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tall Kneel to Stand: Strong Glute Drive

The Tall Kneel to Stand starts from a stable, but stretch glute position. Emphasize this strong glute contraction as you stand up. Focus on feeling the glute on your working side as you drive your foot into the floor.
Stay tall at the top and control the return to the kneeling position — this move builds great glute strength and hip control.
Short on Time? Skip the Strength Intensity

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps
Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Keep weight the same and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (No Pauses at Bottom)
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure). Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust or Machine Hip Thrust; 10 reps @20X0
rest 60 sec
Dual KB Rack Tall Kneel to Stand; 6-8 reps/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure with great form.

E) Overhead Intervals (12-15 min):
Every 60 sec x 12-15 sets (4-5 rounds)

Min 1) 3-5 Wall Walks or 10-12 Inchworm
Min 2) 10-15 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up (25/10#) (male/female)
Min 3) Row 8-12 Cals
Effort Note:
Perform at a controlled pace to give yourself a small amount of rest time between each minute. The first rounds may feel easy, but they should gradually get more challenging.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
Pancake Stretch; 60 sec

Tuesday January 27, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Passive Hang x 1 min

Wednesday January 28, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Bike Buy-In Chipper
Daily Focus Note:
Today's conditioning piece mixes power, control, and grit. You'll start with a significant bike effort (Assault bike, Bike Erg, or any type). Then you proceed to a three-round section that will test your

ability to stay composed under fatigue. The combination of DB Power Cleans and Burpees will challenge your full body strength, and the Star Plank will train your core to stay tight even when you're breathing hard. Think of this workout as a wave: start strong and stay steady through the end. Focus on good movement quality while keeping your effort consistent from start to finish. Short on Time? Reduce Strength Balance to 2 Sets.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
Landmine Lateral Lunge with Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Dual KB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 2.2.2 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Rep Scheme Note:
2.2.2 Cluster Set = Perform the first 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the next 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the last 2 reps. Each set is 6 total reps with rest between every 2 reps.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Barbell Row; 6 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Fatigued Triplet (15 min):
50/40 Cal Bike Buy In (male/female)
+

3 rounds for time
20 Alternating DB Power Clean (50/35)
20 No Jump Burpee
30 sec/side Star Plank
Effort Note:
Push the pace on the Buy In. Perform the Rounds For Time with a controlled pace.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Seal Stretch; 30 sec
Passive Hang; 30 sec
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Thursday January 29, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Friday January 30, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x

A) Daily Focus Notes: Half Kneeling DB Press Core Integration
The Half Kneeling Dumbbell Press combines upper body strength with core control. By pressing from a kneeling stance, your abs and glutes must stay tight to keep your body stable. This teaches proper bracing and improves how your core supports overhead pressing. Focus on pressing straight up while keeping your ribs pulled down and hips square.
Short on Time? Reduce Strength Balance to 2 Sets.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Single Leg Hip Bridge Hold; 30 sec/side
Alternating Single Arm Split Stance KB Swing x 6-10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. The reps are the same as Week 1+3, aim to increase weight by 5-10% from Week 3.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 4-8 reps @32X1 (3 seconds down, 2 second pause at bottom)
rest 30 sec
Half Kneeling Single Arm DB Press; 10/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raises; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) GRINDER (15 min):
15 minutes @ GRINDER pace
45sec Goblet Wall Sit (53/35#) (male/female)
20 KB See Saw Row (10/side) (53/35)
50m Goblet Carry (70/53)
30 Bodyweight Walking Lunge (15/side)
Effort Note:
Some movements chosen for this conditioning section are meant to slow you down. Do not try to race through this, instead focus on a consistent trudge through the 15 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Saturday January 31, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work:
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age).
Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
8 Dual KB Gunslinger
8 Dual KB Clean
8 Alternating KB Press (4/side)
*keep the KB weight very light
Then Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
Then 2 Sets:
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Front Splits
Supine Hamstring Stretch x 1 min/side
Active Straight Leg Raise x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Couch Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Front Split Progression x 10 reps/side
Front Split x 1-2 min/side

Sunday February 1, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PUMP CONDITION 3x
WORK IN LESSON
Lack of motivation isn't a moral failing. Maybe you're trying to force a version of fitness that no longer fits your life.

I understand the fear that if something worked once, it feels like the only way. Changing my training from hours in the gym each day to a handful of hours a week took time, because I was afraid if I stopped doing so much I'd lose all my progress.

For someone who practically lived in the gym, it's actually shocking how little you need when you just do a few things well.

Lift with good effort a few times a week. Walk a lot throughout the day. Manage your calories and protein.

If you're struggling to stay consistent, is there a version that's easier, and still gets the job done?

With love,
Marcus

Perform

Monday January 26, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 – Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Gymnastics HOT START
The quality skill work that has been laid down as a foundation in the first half of this training block can now be expressed under a bit of fatigue. Do not lose quality with the incorporation of a higher heart rate. High skill movements still require quality in order to maintain efficiency.
Short on Time? Reduce Strength Balance to 2 Sets.

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Split Stance Dual KB Deadlift; 8-10 reps/side
Split Stance Dual KB Row; 6-8 reps/side

C) HOT START Gymnastics Pre Fatigue (10-12 min):
Every 3:00 x 3-4 sets
12/10 Cal Bike (male/female)
3-5 Bar or Ring Muscle Up
8-12 Kipping Handstand Push Up
Effort Note:
Quality over speed. The goal is to accumulate great reps with great positions. Aim to give yourself at least 45 seconds of rest between sets.

D) Strength Intensity (12 min):
Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 Tempo - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure). The reps are the same as Week 1+3 - aim to increase weight by 5-10% from Week 3.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3-4 sets
Supinated Barbell Row; 6 reps @21X1
rest 30-60 sec
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Density Hinge (15 min):
50/40 Cal Bike Buy In (Male/Female Calories)
+
4 rounds for time
20 Alternating DB Power Clean (50/35)
12 Burpee Box Step Up (6/side) (24/20")
20-30 sec/side Side Plank Rotations
Effort Note:
Push the pace on the Buy In. Perform the Rounds For Time after with a controlled pace.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Cat Cow x 5 reps
Childs Pose Lat Stretch x 30 sec/side
Downdog to Updog x 5 reps with 2-3 sec hold in each position
Pigeon Stretch; 30-60 sec/side

Tuesday January 27, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 – Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Half Kneeling DB Press Core Integration
The Half Kneeling Dumbbell Press combines upper body strength with core control. By pressing from a kneeling stance, your abs and glutes must stay tight to keep your body stable. This teaches proper bracing and improves how your core supports overhead pressing. Focus on pressing straight up while keeping your ribs pulled down and hips square.
Short on Time? Reduce Conditioning to 9-12 minutes.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps
Half Kneeling Cable or Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Jerk Progression (12 min):
5 working sets; rest 90 sec between sets
2 Pause Split Jerk
Set 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Close Grip Barbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 22X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 22X1 - RPE 9

Working Set 4 - Drop back to your Set 1 and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1 (No Pauses at Bottom)

Loading Note:

Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Strict Bar Dip; 4-6 reps @32X1
rest 30 sec
Half Kneeling Single Arm DB Strict Press; 10 reps/side @21X1
rest 30 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raises; 10 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.

Loading Note:

Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Overhead Intervals (15 min):
Every 60 sec x 15 sets (5 rounds)
Min 1) 3-5 Wall Walks
Min 2) 10-15 Weight Plate Turkish Sit Up (25/10)
Min 3) Row 8-12 Cals
Effort Note:
Perform at a controlled pace to give yourself a small amount of rest time between each minute. The first rounds may feel easy, but they should gradually get more challenging.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Wednesday January 28, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 – Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Nordic Hamstring Curl: High Sets, Low Reps
The Nordic Hamstring Curl is tough — so this week focuses on more sets with fewer reps to keep the quality high. This helps you train your hamstrings hard without losing form. You should be able to use less assistance than in previous weeks.

Move slow and controlled, keeping your hips extended the whole time for maximum strength benefit.
Short on Time? Reduce conditioning to 3 sets.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
directly into
Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
Landmine Lateral Lunge with Rotation; 5-7 reps/side
Dual KB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Speed Strength - Clean (15min):
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Romanian Deadlift
10 Strict Press
10 Front Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Clean Grip Hold
10 sec Front Rack Hold
10 sec Front Squat Hold
+
5 sets; rest 90 sec between sets
2 Power Clean
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Back Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 2.2.2 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 2.2.2 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Rep Scheme Note:

2.2.2 Cluster Set = Perform the first 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the next 2 reps, rack the bar and rest 15sec, perform the last 2 reps. Each set is 6 total reps with rest between every 2 reps.

E) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
V Up; 10 reps
rest 30 sec
Nordic Hamstring Curls or Prone Hamstring Curl Machine or BC Gliding Hamstring Curl; 3 reps @30X0
rest 30 sec
Tuck Up; 20 reps
rest 30 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
For the nordic hamstring curl, use assistance as needed to match the prescription. The reps have decreased allowing for a decrease in assistance. Other hamstring curl variations may be subbed in place of the nordic hamstring curl. Aim for each set to be close to failure. The sets have increased again from Week 3+4.

F) Lower Body Interval Weight Training (12 min):
Every 3mins x 4 Sets
10/side Dual KB Overhead Box Step Up (35/26) (16-20")
20/16 Calorie Bike
*If overhead position is too challenging, perform a Dual KB Rack Step Up
Effort Note:
Prioritize quality on the lower body movement with a sustainable pace on the bike. Any remaining time of the 3 minutes is rest.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Thursday January 29, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 – Persist PERFORM

Active Recovery Day

A) Active Recovery Work:
Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. Go for a jog, hike, walk, ruck, bike, or swim. If you want a GYM OPTION, please use the following. You should keep your heart rate in the Zone 2 range. That can be calculated roughly as 65-75% of your theoretical maximal HR (220-age). Be mindful not to push your intensity too high. Small spikes in heart rate are fine. Just don't attempt to trash your body or muscles.
Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
2 Sets:
8 Dual KB Gunslinger
8 Dual KB Clean
8 Alternating KB Press (4/side)
*keep the KB weight very light
Run/Bike/Row 90 sec @75% effort
rest 30 sec
x 5 Sets
2 Sets:
10 KB Horn Bicep Curls
10 Alternating KB Clean to Rotational Press
10 Hollow Rocks

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold
Russian Babymaker x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps/side

Friday January 30, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 – Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Fast Intervals with Full Effort
Today's workout uses short, intense intervals with built-in recovery to help you push harder each set. The 1:1 work-to-rest ratio means you will rest the same amount of time it takes to complete each set - so make sure to time yourself. Keep your rows powerful and efficient, then move quickly into the push-ups or body rows with solid form. Focus on smooth transitions and strong pacing. Each round should feel challenging but repeatable, with consistent times from start to finish.
Short on Time? Remove Shoulder Pre Fatigue

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps
Ring Y Row; 6-8 reps

C) Shoulder Pre Fatigue: (10 min)
3 Sets for Quality
12 Landmine Meadow Row R
12 Tall Kneeling Landmine Press R
12 Landmine Meadow Row L
12 Tall Kneeling Landmine Press L
6-8 Pike Strict Handstand Push Up @ 30X0
Effort Note:
Take short rests between movements and sets as needed. Keep the loads light to moderate. Your RPE should be closer to 5-6/10 on these sets, saving your intensity for the next strength section.

D) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Barbell Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Use the same weight as previous sets and perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):

3 sets
Alternating Dumbbell Bench Press; 12 reps/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Dumbbell Preacher Curl; 10 reps @20X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

F) Couple of Couplets: (15min)
6/5 Cal Row
12 Ring Pushups
6/5 Cal Row
rest 1:1 x 4 Sets
rest 2 min
6/5 Cal Row
15 Pronated Body Rows
6/5 Cal Row
rest 1:1 x 4 Sets
Effort Note:
For this conditioning piece, make sure to keep track of each round. The time it takes to complete each round, will be the time you will rest between each set. Because of the 1:1 work to rest ratio, push the pace on these intervals.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Saturday January 31, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 – Persist PERFORM

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tall Kneel to Stand: Strong Glute Drive
The Tall Kneel to Stand starts from a stable, but stretch glute position. Emphasize this strong glute contraction as you stand up. Focus on feeling the glute on your working side as you drive your foot into the floor.
Stay tall at the top and control the return to the kneeling position — this move builds great glute strength and hip control.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Single Leg Hip Bridge Hold; 30 sec/side
Alternating Single Arm Split Stance KB Swing x 6-10 reps/side

C) Speed Strength - Snatch (15 min):
Barbell Warm-up:
1-2 Sets (with Empty Barbell)
10 Snatch Grip Romanian Deadlift
10 BTN Snatch Press or BTN Snatch Push Press
10 Overhead Squat
10 sec Squatting Quad Snatch Grip Hold
10 sec Snatch Grip Overhead Hold
10 sec Overhead Squat Hold
+
Every 2:00 x 5 sets
2 Full Snatch
rest until the next 2:00
Sets 1-2: Easy
Set 3-4: Moderate
Set 5: Challenging

D) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Cyclist Front Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Reps are the same as Week 3 - aim to increase weight by about 5%.

E) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Barbell Hip Thrust or Machine Hip Thrust; 10 reps @20X0

rest 60 sec
Dual KB Rack Tall Kneel to Stand; 6-8 reps/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure with great form.

F) GRINDER (15 min):
15 minutes @ GRINDER pace
45sec Goblet Wall Sit (53/35)
20 Split Stance Alternating Single Arm Russian KBS (53/35)
50m Goblet Carry (70/53)
30 Bodyweight Walking Lunge (15/side)
Effort Note:
Some movements chosen for this conditioning section are meant to slow you down. Do not try to race through this, instead focus on a consistent trudge through the 15 minutes.

G) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Seal Stretch; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Sunday February 1, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist PERFORM
WORK IN LESSON
Lack of motivation isn't a moral failing. Maybe you're trying to force a version of fitness that no longer fits your life.

I understand the fear that if something worked once, it feels like the only way. Changing my training from hours in the gym each day to a handful of hours a week took time, because I was afraid if I stopped doing so much I'd lose all my progress.

For someone who practically lived in the gym, it's actually shocking how little you need when you just do a few things well.

Lift with good effort a few times a week. Walk a lot throughout the day. Manage your calories and protein.

If you're struggling to stay consistent, is there a version that's easier, and still gets the job done?

With love,
Marcus

Minimalist

Monday January 26, 2026

Week 5 Day 1 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tempo Progression on Pull Ups
Your pull ups this block follow a tempo progression:
Weeks 1–2: 21X2 (steady control and a pause at the top)
Weeks 3–4: 30X0 (longer eccentric to build strength)
Weeks 5–6: 20X0 (faster and more powerful).
The pull up can be a very hard movement to progress, but tempo is a great tool to break through plateaus.
Short on Time? Reduce conditioning to 9 minutes.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Glute Bridge DB Bench Press; 10 reps
Half Kneeling Band Row; 10 reps/side

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Dumbbell Bench Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 Tempo - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE (Rate of Perceived Exertion - scale of 10, where 10 is form failure). Aim to match weight from Week 3. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):

3-4 sets
Dumbbell Bent Over Row; 8 reps @21X1
rest 60-90 sec
Pronated Strict Pull Up; 8-12 reps @20X0
rest 60-90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Overhead Intervals (12-15 min):
Every 60 sec x 12-15 sets (4-5 rounds)
Min 1) 4-6 Wall Walks or 10-12 Inchworm
Min 2) 10-12 Dual DB Turkish Sit Up (25/10)
Min 3) Shuttle Run; 30-40 sec
*Shuttle Run; Mark two points 10m apart. 1 rep = there and back.
Effort Note:
Perform at a controlled pace to give yourself a small amount of rest time between each minute. The first rounds may feel easy, but they should gradually get more challenging.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Scorpion Chest Stretch; 30 sec/side
Banded Single Arm Behind the Back Stretch; 30 sec/side
Passive Hang; 30 sec

Tuesday January 27, 2026

Week 5 Day 2 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: DB Hamstring March
The DB Hamstring March is a great exercise to explore length in the hamstrings. In true Strength Balance fashion, treat this exercise as a way to build flexibility in the posterior chain, which supports balance around the hips and knees.
Short on Time? Reduce conditioning to 3 sets.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
15 sec Cardio Sprint
directly into

Goblet Heel Sits; 10 reps
Goblet Lateral Lunge; 5-7 reps/side
Dual DB Rack March; 30 seconds

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
Dual Dumbbell Sumo Squat
3 Working Sets; rest 2-3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 6 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Reps have decreased from Week 3, aim to increase weight by 5-10%.

D) Strength Balance (12 min):
3 sets
DB Hamstring March; 4-6 reps/side @30X0
rest 30 sec
V Up; 10 reps
rest 30 sec
DB Hamstring March; 4-6 reps/side @30X0
rest 30 sec
Tuck Up; 10 reps
rest 30 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for Set 1 to be RPE 7-8 and then keep weight the same for the remainder of the sets.

E) Lower Body Interval Weight Training (10 min):
Every 2:00-2:30 x 4 Sets
10/side Dual DB Overhead Box Step Up (35/26) (16-20")
50 Double Unders or 75 Single Unders
*If overhead position is too challenging, perform a Dual KB Rack Step Up
Effort Note:
Prioritize quality on the lower body movement with controlled breathing on the jump rope. Any remaining time is rest. Adjust interval time based on how long you have remaining (ok to adjust mid-workout). Aim for at least 30 seconds of rest before the next set.

F) Cooldown (5 min):

1-2 sets
Foot Elevated Hamstring Stretch; 30 sec/side
Dynamic Couch Stretch; 30 sec/side
Hip Sleeper Stretch; 30 sec/side

Wednesday January 28, 2026

Week 5 Day 3 - Persist MINIMALIST
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Shoulder Mobility
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Shoulder Extension Stretch x 1 min
Shoulder Extension Bridge x 5 reps
Prone I Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Prayer Stretch x 2 min
Prone Y Raise x 5 reps with 5 sec hold
Shoulder Circles x 5 reps/side
Passive Hang x 1 min

Thursday January 29, 2026

Week 5 Day 4 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Half Kneeling DB Press Core Integration
The Half Kneeling Dumbbell Press combines upper body strength with core control. By pressing from a kneeling stance, your abs and glutes must stay tight to keep your body stable. This teaches proper bracing and improves how your core supports overhead pressing. Focus on pressing straight up while keeping your ribs pulled down and hips square.
Short on Time? Remove Strength Balance

B) Warmup (8 min):
3 Rounds
90 sec Cardio of Choice
Prone BTN Press; 6-8 reps

Incline Trap 3 Raise; 6-8 reps

C) Strength Intensity 1 (12 min):
DB Z Press
4 Working Sets; rest 2 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Working Set 4 - Perform Max Unbroken reps @20X1
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. Aim to match weight from Week 1. The reps have increased from 8->10.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
Deficit Push Up; 8-12 @32X1
rest 30 sec
Half Kneeling Single Arm DB Press; 8/side @20X0
rest 30 sec
Seated DB Lateral Raise; 10-12 reps @30X0
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure.

E) Couple of Couplets (15 min):
3 Shuttle Run (10m there and back)
12 Push Up to Shoulder Tap (6/side)
3 Shuttle Run
rest 1:1 x 4 Sets
rest 2 min
3 Shuttle Run
12 DB Power Clean (50/35#) (male/female)
3 Shuttle Run
rest 1:1 x 4 Sets
Effort Note:
For this conditioning piece, make sure to keep track of each round. The time it takes to complete each round, will be the time you will rest between each set. Because of the 1:1 work to rest ratio, push the pace on these intervals.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Theraband Around the World; 6-10 reps
Supinated Passive Hang; 30 sec
PVC Shoulder Extension Stretch; 30-60 sec

Friday January 30, 2026

Week 5 Day 5 - Persist MINIMALIST

A) Daily Focus Notes: Tall Kneel to Stand: Strong Glute Drive
The Tall Kneel to Stand starts from a stable, but stretched glute position. Emphasize this strong glute contraction as you stand up. Focus on feeling the glute on your working side as you drive your foot into the floor.
Stay tall at the top and control the return to the kneeling position — this move builds great glute strength and hip control.
Short on Time? Reduce Strength Balance to 2 sets.

B) Warmup (8 min):
2 min Cardio of Choice
+
3 Sets
Single Leg Hip Bridge Hold; 30 sec/side
Half Kneeling DB Chop and Lift; 6/side

C) Strength Intensity (12 min):
DB Romanian Deadlift
3 Working Sets; rest 3 minutes
Warm-Up Set - 10 reps @ 20X1 - Easy
Working Set 1 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 7
Working Set 2 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 8
Working Set 3 - 10 @ 20X1 - RPE 9
Loading Note:
Keep weight the same for all sets. The accumulated fatigue will lead to an increase in RPE. The reps are the same as Week 1+3, aim to increase weight by 5-10% from Week 3.

D) Strength Balance (15 min):
3 sets
DB Hip Thrust; 10 reps @20X0

rest 60 sec
Dual DB Rack Tall Kneel to Stand; 6-8 reps/side
rest 90 sec and back to 1.
Loading Note:
Aim for each set to be close to failure with great form.

E) GRINDER (15 min):
15 minutes @ GRINDER pace
45-60 sec Goblet Wall Sit (50/35)
20 Alternating DB Snatch (50/35) (10/side)
50m Goblet Carry (50/35)
30 Walking Lunge (15/side)
Effort Note:
Some movements chosen for this conditioning section are meant to slow you down. Do not try to race through this, instead focus on a consistent trudge through the 15 minutes.

F) Cooldown (5 min):
1-2 sets
Seal Stretch; 30 sec
Pancake Stretch; 30 sec
Horse Stance Pulse; 30 sec

Saturday January 31, 2026

Week 5 Day 6 - Persist MINIMALIST
Active Recovery Day

A) OPTIONAL - Active Recovery Work: Goal: Complete 30 minutes of low-intensity steady-state movement today. You can get out for a 30-minute walk, hike on some moderate terrain, or if you like to bike or swim, have at it.

B) PERSIST RECOVERY MOBILITY SESSION:
Squat Mobility
Shinbox Switch x 10 reps/side
Shinbox Thoracic Rotation x 5 reps/side
Shinbox Rear Leg ER + Shinbox Heel Touch x 5 reps/side
Downdog Calf Stretch x 10 reps/side
Weighted Ankle Stretch x 1-2 min/side
Frog Stretch x 1-2 min
Active Hip Flexion x 5 reps/side with 5 sec hold

Russian Babymaker x 10 reps
Squat Thoracic Rotations x 5 reps/side
Squat Hip Rotations x 10 reps/side

Sunday February 1, 2026

Week 5 Day 7 - Persist MINIMALIST
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Lift with good effort a few times a week. Walk a lot throughout the day. Manage your calories and protein.

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Marcus